

Rejuvenating Downtime

Myth Busting

- Downtime is a luxury. This is a complete fallacy because in order to perform over a sustained without burnout we need to take our downtime every bit as seriously as our work. Athletes will do things like ice baths in order to recover speedily from intense bouts of training and as mental athletes (performers in work, family and extracurricular lives) we need to do the same in our own unique way.
- People who believe that by not taking holidays from work they are helping their promotion prospects could be sorely mistaken. In the United States it has been found that people who take all of their holiday days versus those that left 11 or more unused were still 7% more likely to get promoted.
- Working longer means getting more done. In fact, we get to a point of diminishing returns when our thinking halts, our motivation dips, and we start making more mistakes that lead to more rework down the line. On average, we reach that tipping point when we work 50 hours in a week (or 10 hours per weekday).

Downtime In The Evening

- The following activities should be avoided or kept to strict moderation as they have been shown to deplete your rejuvenation and morale: online shopping, web surfing and TV bingeing.
- Look to include activities (great if they involve others) like family rituals, some movement like a jog with a friend and a proven stress reliever in the form of reading. It is much easier to go from 100km per hour in the office to 60km per hour in a different direction when home in the evening. When we aim for 0km per hour, we often find ourselves resorting too much to the evening do nots.
- Be deliberate about not allowing your email or phones to take over your evening. Smart phone use has been shown to make us more selfish and deplete the quality of our interactions.

Downtime On Weekends

- Try not to let chores take over your weekend by considering outsourcing things like shopping or cleaning. Or if you want to do them yourself then look to complete them during high potential hours when you are at your freshest.
- Try to plan your weekend earlier in the week so it is not left to the last minute and you end up wasting it.
- Lastly, an important note for couples is that Art Aron, social psychologist found that couples still very passionately in love after many years threw themselves into hobbies together so the weekend is a good opportunity for you to go hiking or do some salsa with your partner.

